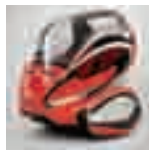


Robot Balls

Sphero, robotic balls that you control with an iPod or Android phone, were all the rage at CES this year. Everyone wants to get a pair of balls now.



Two wheeled car

GM's EN-V (Electric Networked Vehicle) a tiny two wheeled car, dazzled audiences with its Segway-like balancing technology and futuristic design

The first of the two is the Acer Liquid Mini, which is a smaller version of its predecessor, sporting a 3.2-inch screen (480x320), 5MP camera capable of 480p video, 600MHz Qualcomm 7227 processor, 512MB of RAM



Liquid Mini and beTouch E210

and ROM, as well as DLNA/Wi-Fi/Bluetooth/GPS/FM radio connectivity.

The second, beTouch E210, runs on Android Froyo as well, and unconventionally is a full-QWERTY Android phone. It comes with a 2.6-inch screen (320x240), 3.2MP camera, 416MHz ST Ericsson processor, 512MB ROM and 256MB RAM, trackpad, as well as the usual connectivity options.

Motorola Xoom: Android Honeycomb tablet unveiled

If 2010 was the year of the tablet (well maybe just one table – the iPad) then we can comfortably assume that this year we would be looking at hoards of new tablets, each claiming to be the new iPad killer. Motorola triggered off the goldrush this year with its Android 3 (Honeycomb) based tablet – Xoom, at CES. The first tablet to feature Android's Tablet specific OS, Xoom clearly stole the lime light and was awarded the best new gadget in the expo.

Announcements aside, we're eagerly looking forward to its launch in March 2011.

The most awesome part of its specs is the Nvidia Tegra 2 dual core processor and 1GB RAM which is a first for any tablet. With its advanced processing power and Flash support it's speculated that Xoom can easily beat the iPad. It features a 5 megapixel front camera and a 2 megapixel rear camera video chat and video conferencing and would be available in 3G which can be upgraded to 4G with firmware and software updates.

The Xoom comes with a built in 32 GB memory and is upgradeable to 64 GB using a micro SD card. Viewing HD videos on its 10.1inch 1080p screen would be a delight. The software features too seem endless. Demo videos showcase a Google e-book service that has a fabulous browsing system. The widget for the e-book reader can be pulled to the home screen and books can be browsed right there. In fact most content on the home screens is dynamic this way – you get to do so much right there without ever needing to launch the application. There's a revamped Google Maps application that works beautifully with multi-touch. It will have vector images instead of bitmaps and users would be able to use more than two fingers to switch instantaneously between 2D and 3D views. However one of the strangest things was that all this was demo-ed on the CES floor by Motorola reps and booth babes. If you were around and asked them if you could hold the device, play with it, you'd most likely have got a simple “no”,

suggest reports. Something's fishy right? Well we hope not, because if it really performs as much as the buildup, it's going to be one formidable product.

Windows to ARM itself on x86-based System-on-Chip devices

Before Ballmer's keynote at CES came the announcement that most of us were expecting – Microsoft is working on a new version of Windows for



The Moto Xoom

ARM based devices. To be specific though, Microsoft is currently developing a version of Windows that supports a variety of SoC (System-on-Chip) devices, be they ARM-based (like Tegra 2, Snapdragon, OMAP) or x86-based (like Oak Trail and Fusion).

This could potentially make the Windows platform agnostic, as the announcement entailed

the news that the support will be found with the “next version of Windows”, presumably Windows 8. What seems more likely however is that there will be several trial versions for various architectures available earlier this year, before Windows 8 comes out in 2012. Microsoft might just decide to make a tablet/small form factor specific version though, just like it did with Windows XP. The goal is clear however, Microsoft wants to expand its domination on the

PC platform to other form factors, from tablets to smart phones to netbooks.

In Ballmer's words:

“Windows has always been, and will continue to be, about the breadth of hardware and software applications and innovation. We're very excited about the full set of partners for the next version of Windows. NVIDIA, Qualcomm, and Texas Instruments are working on SoC designs based on the ARM architecture. Intel and AMD will continue to innovate on the x86 platform, including the new low-powered SoC systems that will be fully supported by Windows, and will include support for native x86 applications.”

This support for SoC architectures will be full-fledged, extending to more than just the basics, but also to “printing and support for

